

» COVER STORY

A MEDAL, AND A MESSAGE

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“P

ullela, Pullela!

Jolly good, Jolly good!”

The chant rolled around the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium during the semifinal of the World Championships, gathering volume as Gayatri Gopichand and Treesa Jolly tried to pull off what, at the beginning of the tournament, would have seemed almost fanciful.

It was silly, catchy and completely appropriate to the moment. At the same time, there was something wonderfully incongruous about it.

At the start of this competition, few would have imagined a packed Delhi

